
BLEED

Game proposal · TGC Game Jam (GDAI & Infinium26) · Themes: Comic, Twist, Light

Team

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Pitch

Bleed is a two-player game set inside a living comic book. Every level is a single page, and the players leap from panel to panel to stay ahead of a creeping darkness that is draining the book of its colour. A narrator speaking through the comic's caption boxes helps them survive and seems to be the hero of the tale. As the pages turn, the players begin to suspect that the story they have been told is not the true one, and that they may not be the heroes of it.

Concept

The comic book is both the setting and the playing field. Each page is laid out as a grid of panels, and each panel is a small space the players can move through. The white gutters that separate the panels are not safe ground: they act as gaps, walls or hazards that have to be crossed, timed or worked around together. Behind the players, an ink-black force spreads across the page, turning everything it touches to greyscale. Staying ahead of it, and finding a way to the next page, is the heart of each level.

The game is built for two players who need each other to get through a page. Possible directions include complementary abilities (for example one player bridging a gutter while the other carries light through a drained panel), moments where one player holds a path open for the other, and a narrator who gives each player different instructions. The exact abilities are deliberately left open so the team can shape them through prototyping during the jam. The characters may be humanoid comic heroes or more abstract shapes; this is an open art-direction choice.

How the game meets the themes

Comic	The whole game lives inside a comic book. Pages are levels, panels are spaces, gutters are obstacles, and caption boxes are the voice of the story. The look and feel draw on the language of comics.
Light	Light is colour and life on the page; darkness is the absence of both. The consuming force is pure black and leaves greyscale in its wake, so the contrast between lit, coloured panels and drained ones is the main visual and mechanical tension of the game.
Twist	The friendly narrator turns out to be using the players. Following his guidance has been destroying the comic's world, and the players discover that they are the real plague on the book. The game ends with them giving themselves to the darkness to save the comic.

Story arc (outline)

The story is told through a narrator who speaks in the comic's caption boxes, and through the state of the pages themselves. The outline below sets the direction; specific scenes, characters and dialogue will be written during the jam.

- **Opening.** The book is under attack by a spreading darkness. The narrator introduces the players as heroes, helps them survive and comes across as the good guy.
- **Doubt.** The narrator's guidance starts leading somewhere strange. What the captions say and what the pages show stop matching, and each page left behind looks worse than before.
- **Revelation.** Near the end the narrator is steering the players to destroy the world outright. They realise that they are the plague, confront him, and he admits they were being used all along.
- **Ending.** The players stop running, give themselves to the darkness and jump in, and in doing so they save the comic.

Player experience

- **Cooperative and tense.** Two players share the screen and a common threat, so communication and timing matter.
- **Readable at a glance.** Every page reads like a comic page, so players always understand where they are and where they need to go.
- **A story that turns on the player.** The same mechanics feel different once the twist lands: what felt like escape is reframed as harm.
- **Short and complete.** A full play-through of roughly 10 to 15 minutes, in line with the jam's evaluation window.

Art and audio direction

The visual style will be rooted in comic books, and will be explored and settled during the jam; the team may combine different art styles, for example between the comic pages and the playable action. The one fixed idea is contrast: colour marks what is still alive in the book, and the darkness drains it away. Sound and music will follow the same mood and shift in tone as the story turns. All third-party assets will be free, open source or CC0 / CC BY, and credited in CREDITS.md and on the itch.io page.

Scope for the 100-hour jam

- A small set of hand-built comic pages that together form the complete story from opening to ending.
- A core co-op loop of moving between panels, crossing gutters and staying ahead of the darkness.
- The narrator caption system that guides players early on and carries the twist later.
- A browser-playable HTML5/WebGL build published on itch.io, with source in a public GitHub repository.

Stretch goals, only if time allows: extra pages, more varied gutter hazards, alternative endings, and online rather than local multiplayer.

Open questions to resolve during the jam

- Character form: humanoid comic heroes or abstract shapes.
- Exact co-op abilities and how the two players depend on each other.
- How the darkness behaves and how directly it threatens the players at each stage of the story.
- Multiplayer approach: local shared-screen first (planned in Godot 4, exported to HTML5), online as a stretch.

All game code will be written within the 100-hour jam window. Any AI tools used for code, text, art or sound will be fully disclosed in the repository and on the itch.io page; the core design and direction are the team's own.